

Akif Shahzad

Woodbridge, VA 22191

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Areas of Practice

- Customer Inquiry Management (CIM)
- Account management
- Customer Retention & Development
- Key stakeholder relations building
- Training material development
- Employee training
- Project implementation
- Customer performance metrics
- Forecasting
- Performance Tracking
- Project Coordination

Software

- Salesforce
- SQL
- MS Office
- SharePoint
- Power BI
- Google Smartsheets
- One Note
- Zuora
- Tableau
- Microsoft Azure

Industry Lines

- Data Quality
- Customer Retention
- CRM systems

Education

- B.Sc. (Hons): Applied Accountancy-Oxford Brookes University
- Advance Diploma: Accounting & Business Mgmt.: ACCA, Glasgow
- University of Cambridge – O & A levels)

Affiliations

- Association of Chartered Certified Accountants

Professional Summary

Results-driven Senior Data Steward with a passion for driving team success through meticulous attention to detail, strong analytical skills, and effective project management. Demonstrates a proven track record in leading key initiatives with a clear understanding of project roles and responsibilities. Committed to continuous learning and professional growth, with a strong desire to excel in the dynamic fields of Master Data and Project Management.

Professional Experiences

S&P Global – Senior Data Steward, MI Salesforce Master Data: (Sep2022– Present)

- Data Quality Assurance: Ensured the accuracy and reliability of data used for business insights, driving key performance indicators and strategic business decisions.
- Cross-functional Collaboration: Collaborated with upstream and downstream teams to deeply understand the business processes and data workflows, contributing to successful project outcomes and operational improvements.
- Growth and Leadership Opportunities: Actively engaged in multiple growth opportunities by contributing to key projects, leading change management efforts, and participating in value-driven initiatives that enhanced organizational performance.
- Continuous Learning and Upskilling: Committed to ongoing professional development by staying updated with current industry practices, tools, and technologies to drive performance improvements and open new opportunities within and beyond my domain.
- Data Extraction Proficiency: Utilized advanced SQL/SOQL capabilities to extract, manipulate, and analyze large datasets, contributing to data-driven insights and decision-making.
- Project and Program Management: Proven experience in managing complex projects and programs, with a focus on ensuring timely delivery and alignment with business objectives.
- Commercial and Sales Systems Expertise: Leveraged hands-on experience working with Commercial/Sales and Order-to-Cash teams and systems to drive seamless process integration and data management.
- Agile and Scrum Methodologies: Actively contributed to Scrum teams in Agile environments, enhancing collaboration and process efficiency while supporting rapid iteration and continuous improvement in project execution.

S&P Global – Customer Retention Associate: (April-2020–Sep-2022)

- Served as Strategic partner and retention champion to frontline accounts using Customer Retention model as foundation for all retention efforts.
- Effectively facilitated renewals, serving as project manager of all aspects of renewal process, liaising with stakeholder teams and resolving client requests and/or issues.
- Delivered regular revenue forecast updates, identified, and escalated any areas of risk or concern.
- Advised frontline teams on pricing, packaging, and retention strategies, proposals as well as up- sell/cross-sell opportunities.
- Ensured maximum price realization and efficiency in renewal outcomes through proactive strategic planning.
- Extensive experience in CRM tools Salesforce and Sales loft for cadences and Excel for analysis.

S&P Global – Specialist - Senior Associate: (Oct 2017–April 2020)

- CRM Administration and Data Integrity: Managed CRM systems to ensure data integrity while providing Level Two support. Conducted in-depth account research to track customer developments and trends, facilitating accurate sales projections and forecasts.
- Customer Satisfaction Excellence: Addressed complex customer concerns, complaints, and inquiries promptly, achieving 100% positive feedback and maintaining high levels of customer satisfaction.
- Sales Support and Proposal Management: Assisted assigned businesses in achieving sales targets by effectively managing RFPs and bid proposals, contributing to successful sales outcomes.
- Competitive Price Modeling: Performed price modeling for client proposals with minimal supervision, ensuring competitive pricing strategies that aligned with market demands.
- Client Negotiation Support: Created complimentary access cases for clients during price negotiations and contract renewals, enhancing client satisfaction and loyalty.
- Resourceful Merchandise Sourcing: Proactively sourced hard-to-find merchandise from various locations, demonstrating resourcefulness and a strong commitment to meeting customer needs.

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Professional Summary

S&P Global – Analyst: (June 2015–Oct 2017)

- Analyzed business statements and reports to maintain comprehensive financial records, ensuring accurate data entry in the company's database.
- Conducted audits on data sets, verifying accuracy, completeness, and compliance with reporting requirements.
- Collaborated with assigned companies to clarify information gathered from public sources, delivering timely updates and insights.
- Contributed innovative ideas for new data collection methods and product enhancements while effectively troubleshooting issues with data sets.
- Fostered strong coordination within the team and management, ensuring timely completion of tasks and projects.

KPMG – Audit Associate: (Dec 2014 - Mar 2015) KPMG TASEER HADI & CO. CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS, Islamabad

Client: Tower Share (PVT) Limited, Annual Audit for the year ended June 30, 2014

- Gained in-depth knowledge of audit methodologies, approaches, and tools while collaborating with licensed auditors.
- Ensured the accuracy of audit and tax reports as well as year-end financial statements through meticulous proofreading.
- Compiled general ledger entries efficiently, achieving 100% accuracy within tight deadlines.
- Conducted thorough technical and analytical reviews of tax returns to verify accuracy and identify eligible deductions.
- Executed vouching and recalculations of general and administrative expenses, trade payables, and direct costs to ensure compliance.
- Identified key risk areas and gaps in internal controls, developing process notes and risk control matrices to enhance audit planning and execution.
- Recognized for contributing to the successful completion of audits, enhancing overall client satisfaction and trust. Developed understanding of company audit methodology, approach and tools while working under supervision of licensed auditors.
- Vouching and recalculation of General and Admin expenses, Trade and other payables including all direct costs.

Achievements

S&P Global Awards & Nominations

- 2021 Year-end MVP Revenue Enablement- **Winner**
- Q4-2021-Commercial Pricing Employee of the Quarter- **Winner**
- Q1-2021-Commercial Pricing - Employee of the quarter- **Nominee**
- Q3-2020-Commercial Pricing - Employee of the quarter- **Winner**
- Q4-2019- Commercial Enablement Employee of the Quarter- **Winner**
- Sep-2015-Content Start Rookie- **Winner**

References

Jay Sherlock

Senior Sales Manager, Sales core - Capital Markets, S&P Global

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Saif Arshad

Director, Commercial Finance Data Governance - Commercial Solutions, S&P Global

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